

January

30



Tet Offensive

North Vietnamese soldiers began to launch surprise military attacks on multiple sites in South Vietnam, including a US embassy. Their aim was to incite rebellion among the South Vietnamese against US intervention in the Vietnam War.

1968

Born this day

1913 Amrita Sher-Gil, Hungarian-born Indian painter. She studied art in Paris, France, before returning to India, and fused elements of Eastern and Western styles in her modern Indian art.

1959

Unsinkable ship

Danish liner MS *Hans Hedtoft*, which had been called unsinkable and safe, hit an iceberg and sank during its first voyage. None of the 95 people aboard survived. Only a lifebelt was ever recovered.



Also on this day

1649 King Charles I of England was executed in front of crowds gathered in Whitehall, London, after being found guilty of treason.

1933 Adolf Hitler was sworn in as chancellor of Germany, marking the start of his dictatorship.

1948 Mahatma Gandhi, leader of the Indian independence movement, was assassinated at the age of 78 in New Delhi by a Hindu extremist.

First modern suspension bridge

1826

The Menai Suspension Bridge was opened to take vehicles from the island of Anglesey to the northwest coast of Wales. This was the world's first modern suspension bridge.

